

UC6: Receive Outbid Notification

Primary Actor: System (triggered by UC1: Place Bid)

Stakeholders and Interests:

- *Previous highest bidder:* wants to know immediately so they can decide whether to re-enter the bidding
- *Seller:* benefits indirectly — keeping bidders engaged drives the price up
- *System:* must deliver notification reliably and in real time without spamming

Preconditions:

- A new valid bid has just been accepted (UC1, step 7)
- There is a previous highest bidder who is now outbid

Postconditions (success):

- The previous highest bidder receives an in-app (real-time) notification and, if configured, an email
- The notification reflects the new current price

Main Success Scenario:

1. System accepts a new highest bid (from UC1).
2. System identifies the previously highest bidder for this item.
3. System sends a real-time in-app notification: "Someone just beat you to it! You've been outbid," including the new current price.
4. System checks the bidder's notification preferences (from UC-Settings, if configured).
5. If the bidder has email alerts enabled for outbid events, system also sends an email.
6. Bidder sees the notification and may choose to place a new bid (re-entering UC1).

Extensions (Alternate Flows):

- **2a. There is no previous bidder (this is the first bid on the item):**
 1. Skip outbid notification entirely.
 2. Use case ends (no one to notify).
- **4a. Bidder has disabled all notifications:**
 1. System still updates the live price on screen if the bidder is actively viewing the page (per real-time broadcast in UC1), but sends no separate notification/email.
 2. Use case ends.
- **3a. Bidder is not currently online/active on the site:**
 1. In-app notification is queued and shown the next time they log in or open the app.
 2. Email (if enabled) is still sent immediately, since that's the only way to reach an offline user.

Special Requirements:

- Notification delivery should not block or delay the bid-acceptance transaction in UC1 — it should be dispatched asynchronously so a slow notification service can never cause a bid to fail or process late.
- This is a good candidate for testing "eventual delivery" rather than strict real-time guarantees — worth noting as a distinction from the hard-timing requirements in UC1.